SPEAKER · FACILITATOR · **EXPERIENCE DESIGNER**

John Vozenilek, MD



A physician who designs the **simulations, serious games, and learning spaces** *that change how professionals perceive, decide, and act, and who helps leaders decide* **what must stay human** *as AI enters the work.*

20+	308	$24.7M	69	50+
years designing simulation and immersive learning	funded clinical–academic projects launched	awarded across four university partnerships	clinical–academic teams formed	peer-reviewed papers; a simulator patent

01 One craft, four boundaries

Every offering comes from the same craft: designing an experience so that people leave seeing, deciding, or working differently. What changes is the boundary being crossed.

OFFERING 01

HUMAN ↔ MACHINE

What Must Stay Human

Most AI talks ask what the technology can do. This one asks what leaders must deliberately keep human, and how to know whether they have.

`drvoz.github.io/bespoke/topics/what-must-stay-human.html`

OFFERING 02

KNOWING ↔ DOING

Designing Experience That Changes Behavior

What two decades of immersive simulation, serious games, and behavioral engineering teach about how capable adults actually learn and change.

`drvoz.github.io/bespoke/topics/designing-experience.html`

OFFERING 03

PLACE ↔ BEHAVIOR

Space as a Leadership Tool

How the design of physical and experiential territory shapes collaboration, learning, and safety, and how to test a space before anyone depends on it.

`drvoz.github.io/bespoke/topics/space-as-leadership.html`

OFFERING 04

THOSE WHO DO ↔ THOSE WHO DISCOVER

Crossing the Blood–Brain Barrier

A tested method for building partnerships between operations and research: matching needs to skills and data, framing hypotheses, and agreeing on outcomes.

`drvoz.github.io/bespoke/topics/blood-brain-barrier.html`

02 Formats

45-90 MIN

Keynote

Story-driven, with live audience moments.

HALF / FULL DAY

Workshop

Do the thing, then debrief it.

COHORT OR 1:1

Partnership design

Match needs, skills, and data.

1-3 DAYS · PEORIA

Immersive visit

Hands-on simulation at Jump.

MULTI-SESSION

Program module

Woven into an executive program.

03 The story behind the work

“The hardest thing in that room wasn't the science. It was the bridge.”

In 2008, as co-chair of a federally funded national consensus conference on simulation science, John realized that the hardest problem wasn't the science. It was getting people who know different things to build something together. That conference produced seven papers he co-authored in a single issue of *Academic Emergency Medicine*, and it set the course of his career. Since 2014 he has designed the workshops and frameworks behind OSF HealthCare's university partnerships: 69 clinical–academic teams and 308 funded projects across four universities. Today he teaches that craft to the next generation of physician innovators, and asks what must remain human as AI enters the work.

04 Signature stories

Rehearse first
Bringing new technology into rural emergency departments through in-situ simulation: the 3-Act-3-Debrief model.
An AI rollout is a new device in the room. Rehearse it.

Name the unknown
A mobile game and randomized trial teaching physicians to communicate uncertainty.
As tools sound more confident, people must name what isn't known.

Rehearse the building
An in-situ simulation that revealed hidden hazards in a new clinical space before it opened.
Test a space like a prototype.

The method travels
One partnership model, four universities: 69 teams, 308 funded projects, $24.7M.
Building bridges is a skill, and it can be designed.

05 Selected engagements

Cybernetic Systems for Clinical Overwatch / AI for Rural Health: keynote, UIC College of Medicine Rockford Research Day

Utilizing AI for Healthy Aging in Austerity: featured panel, AI + Health Summit, University of Illinois (2024)

Plenary, Health Care Engineering Systems Symposium, University of Illinois and Jump (annual)

Keynote, *Illinois Innovation Index* release: Illinois Science & Technology Coalition executive briefing

If It Plays in Peoria: featured keynote, SimGHOSTS USA

Game Changing Technology: Transforming Teams: Illinois Hospital Association Quality Leadership Conference

Co-chair, AEM Consensus Conference on the Science of Simulation, Washington, DC (2008)

06 International

Brazil (2026): CONFAP–Illinois grant with FIOCRUZ-Amazônia

Czech Republic (2015): Invited lectures, Brno

France (2012–2013): Visiting Professor, University of Nice

Canada (2005): Grand Rounds, McGill University

Australia (2004–2008): Course co-design with RMIT University

07 Appointments

Vice President, Philanthropy, Academic Partners & Breakthrough Strategy, OSF HealthCare · Jump Trading Simulation & Education Center

Duane and Mary Cullinan Professor in Simulation Outcomes

Professor of Clinical Emergency Medicine, University of Illinois College of Medicine at Peoria

Clinical Professor of BioEngineering and Landuyt Center for Entrepreneurship, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Illinois “Innovator to Know” (2023)

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▶ Watch first: medDesign podcast, from 7:40 · youtu.be/jqdyr2kO16M?t=460